

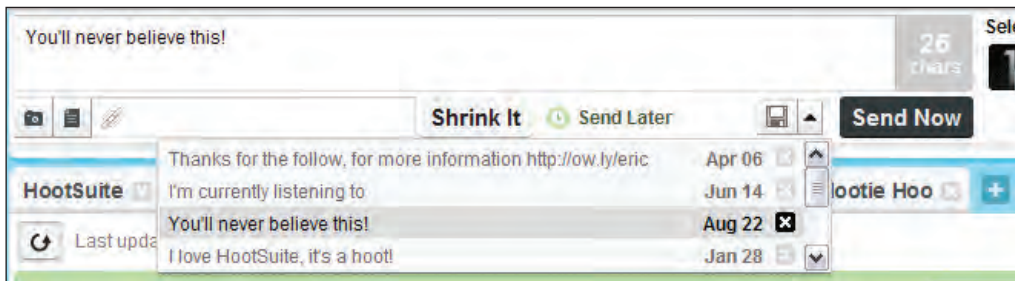
Google Secure Search

Google has announced the Secure Socket Layer (SSL) offering to its Search application

Pakistan bans social media

Pakistan banned social media sites like Facebook, YouTube and Twitter after a group called users to submit caricatures of Prophet Muhammad

Web watch



HootSuite can store multiple draft messages for easy reuse.

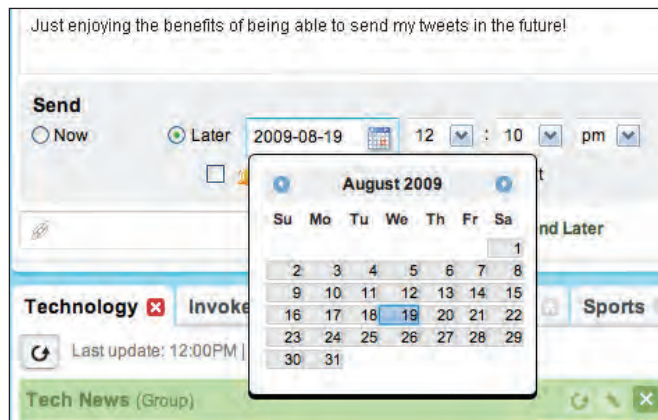
ents: delayed messages, drafts, statistics, RSS feeds, and collaboration. Most of these are features which are not very feasible with desktop clients.

Drafts, as their name suggests are messages which are saved in your account but not sent. You might question their utility considering that a Twitter message is as short as 140 characters. Who needs to keep a draft of 140 characters! However when you have fewer words to send, you need to pick them more wisely. Also, if you need to send similar tweets again and again, drafts can save you the trouble of retyping. Remember that other networks don't have a 140-character limit for drafts.

Delayed messages are another awesome feature. They let you queue up messages for your social networking services, to be sent at a scheduled time in the future. So if you are having a contest on a social networking site and need to post a question every hour, this can be of immense use. Of course you can also use this to schedule messages throughout 24 hours to make it seem like you never sleep!

HootSuite includes its own URL shortener, and if you use its shortening feature, it can collect statistics on clicks and show them to you.

The RSS feature in HootSuite is similar to the one you find in TwitterFeed: it's a service with the sole purpose of posting



You can schedule your social messages for any time, so you needn't be online when the message needs to be sent.

updates to supported social networking accounts, in sync with your RSS feed. The collaborative features of HootSuite, as we mentioned earlier, allow you to

set up multiple team members for social networking accounts, allowing all of them to post messages to your social networking accounts without needing them

to know its password – keeping you in control. HootSuite can also automatically prepend your initials to messages you send as a team member, so people know where the message is coming from. Finally, the assignments feature lets you assign tasks to team members in HootSuite; so you could assign specific people to respond to help messages on Twitter, or to respond to a complaint or query.

HootSuite is definitely one of the most powerful, and flexible social networking applications out there, and the fact that it is a browser application just means that it is accessible from anywhere. Unlike desktop applications, you are not lost when you are not on your own computer with the application of your choice installed. The only complaint we have with it is that the plethora of features can be intimidating for some users. However, for those who need the features it is a boon. For anyone using or handling multiple social networking accounts, HootSuite is a must-try. **d**

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